in public diplomacy and how culture has assumed an increasingly salient role in India's external relations. Defined rather broadly, India's soft power is often described in relation to the Bollywood film industry or British preferences for Indian cuisine, with little attention given to *how* this increases India's influence abroad. There is also sparse work on how decision-makers think about, define, and invest in promoting Indian soft power.[20]

Two trends stand out in how the Indian government has addressed soft power as part of its larger foreign policy priorities in recent years. The first trend relates to the *ideological* investment of the Bharatiya Janata Party in enhancing India's soft power. While cultural diplomacy has been part of India's diplomatic agenda for decades, the BJP-led government of Prime Minister Modi has emphasised the importance of soft power to promote Indian influence abroad. Even before being elected, Modi repeatedly argued for a more assertive cultural diplomacy. Speaking at a conference of the International Advertising Association, in 2013, he underlined that "[The] world does not run with military or economic power only. Biggest strength is soft power. We are so rich in soft power and no one can be as rich as us. What do we not have[?]. We need to market it."[21] He would later observe that "where power and regency are not accessible, at such places, soft power plays an important role in international relations."[22] Modi has defined this role of soft power as "deeper, more personal, and therefore, far more powerful."[23]

Similarly, by highlighting various commonalities between the cultures of India and other countries and forging personal relationships with their leaders, Prime Minister Modi is asserting his belief that by working together, one can "convert shared ideals into practical cooperation."[24] His speeches reflect the importance he gives to persuasion, beyond just power, with a vision based on "cooperation not